

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 9 2
♥ 7
♦ 10 6 5 3 2
♣ 8 5 3

♠ 10 7 3
♥ K J 5 4
♦ K 7
♣ A Q 10 6



♠ Q 6 5 4
♥ 9 6
♦ A Q J 9
♣ K 7 2

♠ A 8
♥ A Q 10 8 3 2
♦ 8 4
♣ J 9 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South

If the ♣ finesse works you have no ♣ loser, and as a bonus you will be able to discard one of your other losers. Even if the finesse fails you still have an extra winner for the discard.

Is there a danger here? Yes. Suppose you win the first trick, pull trumps, then finesse the ♣. East might win and play a ♠ back to West's hand. And West might then lead a ♦ through dummy's ♦ K.

West is the Danger Hand. You want to keep him off the lead. His only possible entry is the ♠ suit, so all you have to do is hold up on the first trick. Win the second ♠, pull trumps as before, and finesse the ♣. East wins but cannot get to his partner's hand for the killing ♦ lead. You will discard one of your ♦ losers on dummy's fourth ♣.

You usually think of a hold-up play in a Notrump contract, trying to exhaust one defender of his partner's suit.

For this deal the hold-up serves a different purpose. It keeps one defender from ever gaining the lead.

You had to lose one ♠ in any case, so you just choose to lose it to the defender who cannot hurt you.

Notice that the Danger Hand **WAS** on lead at one point - the opening lead. If West had been clairvoyant enough to lead a ♦ the contract could have been beaten. Opening leads are important to the defense.

Don't even think of jumping to 2♥. That would show 17+ points. Instead you just bid 1♥, knowing partner is forced to bid again.

Partner does bid again, saying 2♥.

Partner's rebid promises a minimum opening bid (13-15) and four ♥s. That makes your total about 28 points and ten ♥s. So you bid game.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠ 2, East playing the ♠ Q.

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Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 4

♥ 4

♦ 7 6 3

♣ K 6 4 3

♠ 7 2

♥ K Q 8 7 6 3

♦ K 9 4

♣ 8 5



♠ 9 6 5 3

♥ 10 9 5 2

♦ A 8 5

♣ 10 9

♠ A K

♥ A J

♦ Q J 10 2

♣ A Q J 7 2

West	North	East	South
	2♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by South

Partner replies 3♦.

Trust your partner. He has shown a better-than-minimum Weak-2 bid, probably 9-11 points, and a high card in ♦s, either the ♦A or ♦K.

With your hand you don't need anything else to make a slam. You have to decide between 6♥ and 6NT. Based on your reluctance to have an opening ♣ lead go through your ♣ A Q you choose 6NT.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♠Q.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♠Q.

Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 6? : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 9

The winner list isn't as bad as it looks, once you drive out the ♦A you'll have your three extra winners in ♦s.

In fact, your only real problem is making sure you get all 6 ♥ winners. If the ♥s split 3-2 it's easy, but if they are 4-1 you cannot afford to overtake the ♥J at the second trick. Fortunately dummy has both the ♦K and the ♦9.

Win the ♠A. Play ♥A and ♥J. West shows out on the second one. Lead your ♦2 to dummy's ♦9. Either you are in dummy now to run the ♥s, or East wins the trick with the ♦A. In this case you can win his return (don't finesse if he leads a ♣), and get to dummy with the ♦K to run the ♥s.

A 4-1 split isn't as likely as a 3-2 split.

But when you can

In this case dummy had a certain entry in the ♦ suit so you take advantage of that entry.

You were probably stunned when you picked up this hand and even more stunned when partner bid.

Your biggest problem is that partner has opened with a weak bid and won't credit you with such a huge hand. So you must make sure you don't make a bid he might pass until you're ready.

For example, suppose you made a jump shift to 4♣. Would partner know what that meant? Do you know what it meant?

The best(?) bid at this point is probably 2NT. Everybody knows what that means. Partner is forced to reply, and will either rebid his suit with a minimum hand or show a "feature" if his hand is better than minimum.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 6
♥ A
♦ A K J 9 6 5
♣ 9 7 5 2

♠ 7 3
♥ 5 4 3 2
♦ Q 4
♣ A K 10 8 3

♠ K 10 9 8 5 2
♥ 9 7
♦ 10 2
♣ Q J 4

♠ A J 4
♥ K Q J 10 8 6
♦ 8 7 3
♣ 6

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
2 ♦	2 ♥	2 ♠	Pass
Pass	3 ♥		
All Pass			
3 ♥ by South			